



TONE & TIGHTEN

FREE GUIDE

A WORKOUT AND FOOD GUIDE

TONE AND TIGHTEN

A workout and food guide for women who already train, and want the work to show.

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GROCERY LIST

What Toning Actually Is

If you are reading this, you are probably not starting from zero. You move, you eat reasonably well, and you are in better shape than most people you know. And yet there are two or three places on your body that never seem to change no matter how consistent you are.

Here is the part almost nobody says plainly: **you cannot choose where your body loses fat.** Sit ups do not flatten a stomach, and inner thigh machines do not slim thighs. Spot reduction has been tested repeatedly and it does not happen. Any guide that sells you a workout for one body part is selling you something that does not exist.

So what is "toning" then? It is two things happening at once. **You build a little more muscle underneath, and you carry a little less over the top.** The muscle is what creates shape. The lower body fat is what lets you see it. Everything in this guide serves one of those two jobs, and nothing in it pretends to serve both from a single exercise.

That is why this is a workout guide and a food guide in the same document. Training builds the shape. What you eat decides whether it shows. Doing one without the other is the single most common reason a consistent person stays stuck.

The one big idea: shape comes from muscle you build, not from fat you target. Train to build it, eat to reveal it, and give it longer than you think it should take.

The Four Levers

There are only four things that reliably change how your body looks, and you already have access to all of them.

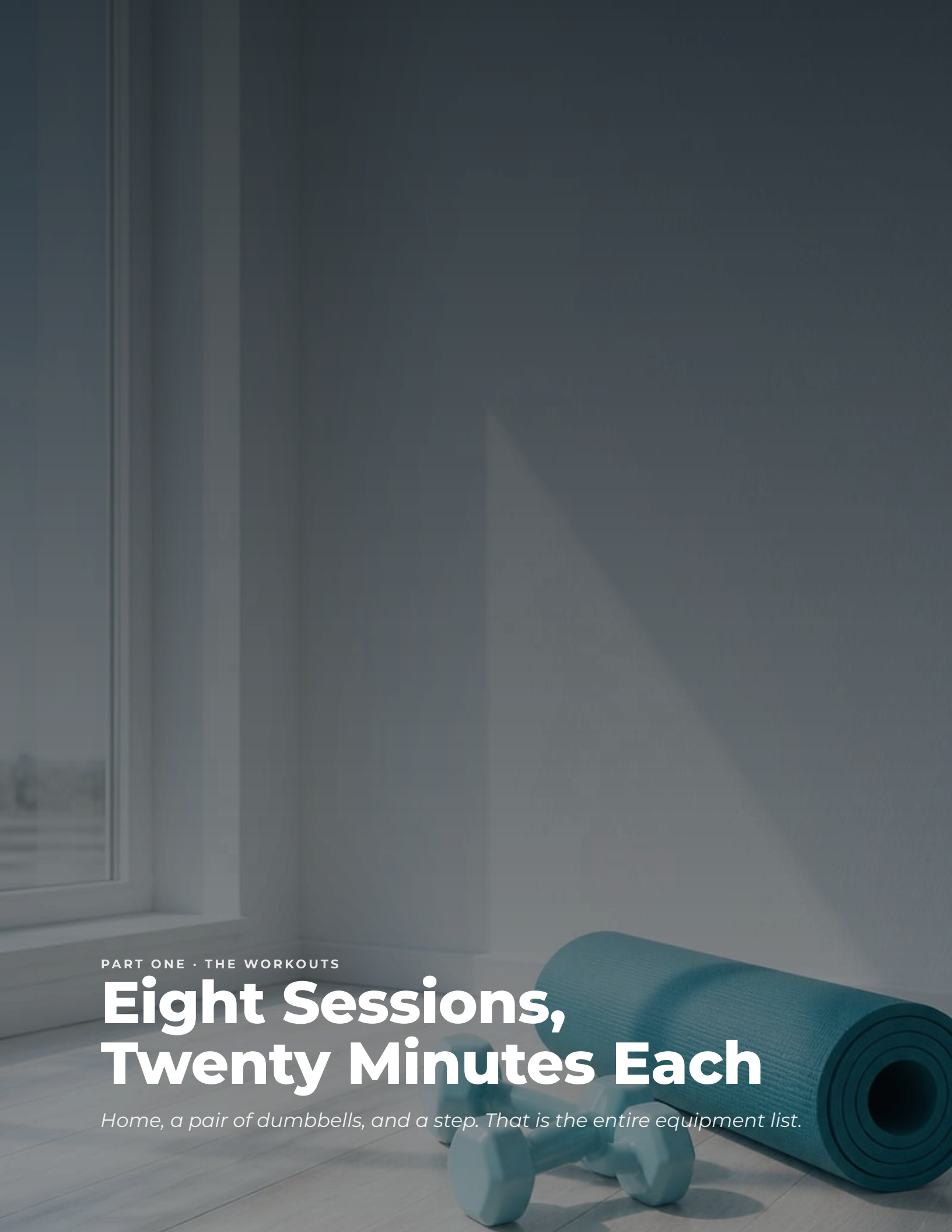
1. Resistance, done properly. Muscle changes shape when you ask it to do something hard and then ask it to do something slightly harder next time. That is the whole mechanism. Twenty minutes of real effort twice a week beats an hour of moving around five times a week, every time.

2. Progressive overload. The same eight workouts done at the same weight for eight weeks will not change much. Each workout in here has a "make it harder" line, and using it is not optional. It is the difference between exercising and training.

3. Protein, at a level you are probably not hitting. Most active women eat roughly half the protein they need to hold onto muscle while eating lighter. Every recipe in the back half of this guide is built around fixing that, and the target is on the food page.

4. Sleep and recovery. Muscle is built between sessions, not during them. Two hard sessions a week that you recover from will out perform five that you do not. If you are training every day and nothing is changing, this is usually why.

That is the whole playbook. The rest of this guide is the specific workouts, the specific schedule, and the specific food, so that none of it requires a decision from you at six in the morning.



PART ONE • THE WORKOUTS

Eight Sessions, Twenty Minutes Each

Home, a pair of dumbbells, and a step. That is the entire equipment list.

The Workouts

01 The Hinge and Bridge

FOUNDATION

Glutes, hamstrings, lower back.

The two movements that build the most shape through the hips, and the ones most people either skip or do badly. Everything else in this guide gets easier once these are strong.

Run it. 3 rounds. 10 dumbbell or bodyweight hip hinges, 12 glute bridges held two seconds at the top, 10 hinges again with a slower lowering. Rest 60 seconds between rounds.

Make it harder: Single leg glute bridges, or hold a dumbbell across your hips.

02 Split Squat Standards

FOUNDATION

Quads, glutes, balance, one side at a time.

Training one leg at a time exposes the side that has been quietly doing less, and fixing that imbalance changes how you look standing still. It is also the most honest twenty minutes in this guide.

Run it. 3 rounds per leg. 8 split squats, 8 reverse lunges, 20 second hold at the bottom of a split squat. Rest 45 seconds, switch legs.

Make it harder: Elevate the back foot, or hold a dumbbell in each hand.

03 Row, Press, Repeat

FOUNDATION

Upper back, shoulders, arms, posture.

Shoulders and upper back are where "toned" reads fastest on a woman who already trains, and they are usually the least trained. Pulling twice for every push is what keeps the shape balanced.

Run it. 4 rounds. 10 bent over rows, 8 overhead presses, 10 rows again, 30 second rest. Keep the ribs down on the press.

Make it harder: Slow the lowering to three seconds, or add weight to the rows first, the press second.

04 The Core Brace

BUILD

Deep core, obliques, anti rotation.

Not a sit up in sight, on purpose. The core's real job is resisting movement, and training it that way is what flattens the way you carry yourself. Remember it will not burn fat off your stomach, and nothing else will either.

Run it. 4 rounds. 30 second front plank, 20 second side plank each side, 10 slow dead bugs, 8 bird dogs each side. Rest 45 seconds.

Make it harder: Add a pause, then add a dumbbell held out in front on the dead bugs.

05 Step Up Intervals

BUILD

Legs, glutes, heart rate.

The one session in here that gets you genuinely out of breath while still building the lower body. A stair or a sturdy chair is the whole equipment list.

Run it. 6 rounds. 40 seconds of step ups alternating legs, 20 seconds off. Then 3 rounds of 10 slow step downs per leg, controlled the whole way.

Make it harder: Raise the step, or hold dumbbells at your sides.

06 The Full Body Twenty

BUILD

Everything, in one circuit.

For the week where you get one session. Every major movement pattern in twenty minutes, so nothing goes untrained even when the schedule collapses.

Run it. 5 rounds, 60 seconds rest between. 8 squats, 8 rows, 8 hip hinges, 6 presses, 30 second plank.

Make it harder: Cut the rest to 40 seconds before you add any weight.

07 Density Day

ADVANCED

Full body, under time pressure.

Same work, less rest. This is how you keep progressing once adding weight every week stops being realistic, and it is where weeks six to eight get their edge.

Run it. Set a timer for 15 minutes. 6 squats, 6 rows, 6 presses, 6 hinges, as many rounds as you can while every rep still looks clean. Write the round count down.

Make it harder: Beat last week's round count by one. That is the only progression this workout needs.

08 The Ten Minute Finisher

TEN MINUTES

Glutes and core, no equipment.

The session for the day you are not going to train. Ten minutes on the floor beats the zero you were about to do, and the habit is worth more than the workout.

Run it. 3 rounds, no rest inside a round. 15 glute bridges, 20 second side plank each side, 10 reverse lunges per leg, 30 second front plank.

Make it harder: Add a fourth round. If you can do five, you are ready for W1 with weight.

The Eight Week Schedule

Three sessions a week. Never two hard days back to back. If you miss one, you do not make it up, you simply carry on with the next one in the list.

Weeks 1 and 2, learn the movements. Monday W1, Wednesday W3, Friday W5. Keep the weight light enough that the last rep of every set still looks like the first one. Write down what you used.

Weeks 3 to 5, add load. Monday W1, Wednesday W4, Friday W2, and swap in W6 for whichever one you like least. Each week, either add a little weight or add one rep per set to at least one movement. That is progressive overload and it is the entire job.

Weeks 6 to 8, add density. Same workouts, shorter rests. W7 replaces one session a week. On a day when life wins, W8 takes ten minutes and still counts.

On the other days, walk. Not as a workout, as a habit. It is the cheapest thing on this list and the one people skip first.

Track two numbers only: the weight you used and the reps you got. If neither has moved in three weeks, that is your signal to change something, and it is almost always the weight.



PART TWO · THE FOOD

Twelve High Protein Recipes

The half that decides whether the training shows.

The Food Half

The training builds it. The food decides whether you see it. You do not need a diet, and there is no meal plan in this guide, because a meal plan is the thing everyone abandons in week two.

There is one number worth knowing. **Aim for roughly 0.7 grams of protein per pound of your body weight per day.** For a lot of women that lands somewhere between 100 and 140 grams. If you are eating half of that right now, which is common, closing that gap will do more for how you look than any change to your workouts.

Protein is doing two jobs here. It is the raw material for the muscle you are building, and it is far more filling per calorie than carbs or fat, which quietly makes eating a little lighter feel like less of a fight.

The simple version: put a real protein at the centre of every meal, add a vegetable, and let the carbs be whatever is left. Every one of the twelve recipes that follows is built to that shape, and each one tells you the protein it delivers so you can stop guessing.

Two habits that cost nothing. Eat the protein on your plate before the starch. And drink enough water that you are not confusing thirst for hunger at four in the afternoon.

A quick, honest note. This is general wellness information, not medical or nutritional advice, and it is not a weight loss program. Individual results vary. If you are pregnant, nursing, managing a condition or taking medication, talk to your healthcare provider before changing how you train or eat.



RECIPE 01 / 12

SERVES 2

Overnight Protein Oats

The breakfast that gets most people from thirty grams of protein a day to a hundred. Made the night before, eaten cold, no decision required.

380

CAL

32g

PROTEIN

42g

CARBS

9g

FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Rolled oats	1 cup
Plain Greek yogurt	1 cup
Milk of choice	1 cup
Vanilla or unflavoured protein powder	2 scoops
Chia seeds	2 tbsp
Berries	1 cup
Cinnamon	1 tsp

METHOD

1. Stir the oats, yogurt, milk, protein powder, chia and cinnamon together in a jar.
2. Seal and refrigerate overnight, or at least four hours.
3. Top with berries in the morning. Keeps three days.



RECIPE 02 / 12

SERVES 1

Cottage Cheese Berry Bowl

Two minutes, thirty grams of protein, and the highest protein per calorie of anything in this guide. The one to keep in your back pocket.

260

CAL

30g

PROTEIN

18g

CARBS

6g

FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Low fat cottage cheese	1 cup
Mixed berries	$\frac{3}{4}$ cup
Ground flax	1 tbsp
Pistachios, chopped	1 tbsp
Cinnamon	a pinch
Honey, optional	1 tsp

METHOD

1. Spoon the cottage cheese into a bowl.
2. Pile the berries on top, scatter the flax and pistachios.
3. Dust with cinnamon and add the honey only if you want it.



RECIPE 03 / 12

SERVES 4

Sheet Pan Chicken And Greens

One tray, one cleanup, four dinners. This is the recipe that makes the whole week work, so cook it on the day you have the most time.

420
CAL

44g
PROTEIN

22g
CARBS

17g
FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Chicken thighs, boneless	2 lb
Broccoli, in florets	1 large head
Red onion, wedged	1
Bell peppers, sliced	2
Extra virgin olive oil	3 tbsp
Smoked paprika	2 tsp
Garlic, minced	4 cloves
Lemon	1
Salt and pepper	to taste

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 425F.
2. Toss everything except the lemon with the oil, paprika, garlic, salt and pepper.
3. Spread across one large tray in a single layer. Crowding it steams the vegetables instead of roasting them.
4. Roast 25 to 30 minutes, until the chicken is cooked through and the edges have colour.
5. Squeeze the lemon over the whole tray before serving.



RECIPE 04 / 12

SERVES 4

Salmon And Sweet Potato Tray

Protein and omega 3 fats in the same tray, with a carb that actually keeps you full. Cook the potatoes ahead and they finish in the time the salmon takes.

470

CAL

38g

PROTEIN

34g

CARBS

20g

FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT

AMOUNT

Salmon fillets	4 (about 6 oz each)
Sweet potatoes, cubed	2 large
Asparagus, trimmed	1 bunch
Extra virgin olive oil	2 tbsp
Dijon mustard	1 tbsp
Lemon, zest and juice	1
Dill, chopped	2 tbsp
Salt and pepper	to taste

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 400F. Toss the sweet potato in half the oil, roast 20 minutes.
2. Whisk the remaining oil with the mustard, lemon and dill.
3. Add the salmon and asparagus to the tray, spoon the dressing over the fish.
4. Roast a further 12 to 14 minutes, until the salmon flakes.



RECIPE 05 / 12

SERVES 4

Herbed Turkey Meatballs

Freezer friendly, and the fastest way to add real protein to a bowl of whatever you already have. Make a double batch, freeze half raw.

340

CAL

36g

PROTEIN

12g

CARBS

16g

FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Ground turkey	2 lb
Egg	1
Rolled oats, blitzed	½ cup
Parsley, chopped	¼ cup
Garlic, minced	3 cloves
Feta, crumbled	½ cup
Oregano	2 tsp
Salt and pepper	to taste

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 400F and line a tray.
2. Mix everything gently. Overworking the mix makes the meatballs tight.
3. Roll into 20 balls and space them out on the tray.
4. Bake 18 to 20 minutes until cooked through.
5. Serve over greens, in a wrap, or on the barley bowl below.



RECIPE 06 / 12

SERVES 6

Chicken And White Bean Soup

Protein and soluble fiber in the same bowl, which is the combination that keeps you full longest. Better on day two, which is the point.

310
CAL

33g
PROTEIN

28g
CARBS

7g
FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Chicken breast or thigh	1.5 lb
White beans, drained	2 cans
Onion, diced	1
Carrots, diced	3
Celery, diced	3 stalks
Garlic, minced	4 cloves
Chicken stock	8 cups
Kale, shredded	4 cups
Olive oil	1 tbsp
Thyme, salt, pepper	to taste

METHOD

1. Soften the onion, carrot and celery in the oil for 8 minutes.
2. Add the garlic and thyme, then the stock and the chicken.
3. Simmer 20 minutes, lift the chicken out, shred it, return it to the pot.
4. Add the beans and kale, simmer 5 more minutes.



RECIPE 07 / 12

SERVES 4

Steak And Barley Bowl

Barley holds its texture for days where rice goes to paste, so this is the lunch that survives being made on Sunday.

480
CAL

40g
PROTEIN

45g
CARBS

16g
FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Lean steak	1.5 lb
Pearl barley	1.5 cups dry
Cucumber, diced	1
Cherry tomatoes, halved	2 cups
Red onion, thin sliced	½
Parsley, chopped	1 cup
Olive oil	3 tbsp
Lemon juice	3 tbsp
Salt and pepper	to taste

METHOD

1. Cook the barley to package directions, drain and cool.
2. Season the steak well and cook to your liking. Rest it 8 minutes before slicing, every time.
3. Toss the barley with the vegetables, parsley, oil and lemon.
4. Slice the steak across the grain and lay it over the top.



RECIPE 08 / 12

MAKES 12

Egg And Feta Breakfast Cups

Two of these is fourteen grams of protein you did not have to think about. They reheat in ninety seconds and keep four days.

110

CAL

9g

PROTEIN

3g

CARBS

7g

FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Eggs	10
Spinach, chopped	3 cups
Feta, crumbled	$\frac{3}{4}$ cup
Bell pepper, small dice	1
Green onion, sliced	3
Milk	$\frac{1}{4}$ cup
Salt and pepper	to taste

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F and oil a 12 hole muffin tin properly.
2. Whisk the eggs with the milk, salt and pepper.
3. Divide the vegetables and feta between the holes, pour the egg over.
4. Bake 20 to 22 minutes until set and just puffed.



RECIPE 09 / 12

SERVES 4

Shrimp And Quinoa Salad

The fastest real dinner in the guide. Shrimp cooks in three minutes and quinoa brings protein of its own, which most grains do not.

390

CAL

35g

PROTEIN

38g

CARBS

11g

FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Shrimp, peeled	1.5 lb
Quinoa	1.5 cups dry
Avocado, diced	1
Cucumber, diced	1
Cilantro, chopped	1 cup
Lime, juice and zest	2
Olive oil	2 tbsp
Chili flakes	½ tsp

METHOD

1. Cook the quinoa, drain well and spread it out to cool.
2. Sear the shrimp in a hot pan, 90 seconds a side, no longer.
3. Whisk the lime, oil and chili flakes together.
4. Fold everything through the quinoa and eat warm or cold.



RECIPE 10 / 12

SERVES 2

Tuna Smash On Toast

Five minutes, thirty grams of protein, ingredients that live in the cupboard. This is the recipe for the day you were going to skip lunch.

350

CAL

31g

PROTEIN

26g

CARBS

13g

FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Tuna in water, drained	2 cans
Plain Greek yogurt	3 tbsp
Dijon mustard	1 tsp
Celery, fine dice	1 stalk
Red onion, fine dice	2 tbsp
Lemon juice	1 tbsp
Wholegrain bread	2 thick slices
Salt and pepper	to taste

METHOD

1. Smash the tuna with the yogurt, mustard and lemon.
2. Fold in the celery and onion, season well.
3. Toast the bread properly and pile it on.



RECIPE 11 / 12

SERVES 2

Greek Yogurt Protein Pudding

The dessert that stops the nine o'clock kitchen visit from undoing the day. Thirty grams of protein and it tastes like a treat.

240

CAL

30g

PROTEIN

16g

CARBS

5g

FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Plain Greek yogurt	1.5 cups
Chocolate or vanilla protein powder	1 scoop
Cocoa powder	1 tbsp
Vanilla extract	1 tsp
Milk, to loosen	2 tbsp
Raspberries	½ cup
Dark chocolate, grated	1 tsp

METHOD

1. Whisk the yogurt, protein powder, cocoa and vanilla until completely smooth.
2. Loosen with the milk a spoonful at a time.
3. Chill 20 minutes, then top with raspberries and the grated chocolate.



RECIPE 12 / 12

SERVES 1

Kefir Recovery Smoothie

For the twenty minutes after a session, when you are not hungry enough to eat but should be getting protein in anyway.

320

CAL

33g

PROTEIN

34g

CARBS

6g

FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Plain kefir	1.5 cups
Protein powder	1 scoop
Frozen banana	1 small
Frozen berries	1 cup
Ground flax	1 tbsp
Spinach	a large handful

METHOD

1. Put the liquid in the blender first, then everything else.
2. Blend 45 seconds until completely smooth.
3. Drink it within the hour. It separates if it sits.

The Master Grocery List

Everything the twelve recipes need, grouped the way a shop is laid out.

Proteins: chicken thighs and breast, lean steak, ground turkey, salmon, shrimp, canned tuna, eggs

Dairy: plain Greek yogurt, low fat cottage cheese, kefir, feta, milk of choice

Pantry protein: whey or plant protein powder, vanilla and chocolate

Grains: rolled oats, pearl barley, quinoa, wholegrain bread

Legumes: white beans, chickpeas

Seeds and nuts: chia, ground flax, pistachios, almonds

Fruit: berries, bananas, lemons, limes, avocado

Vegetables: broccoli, asparagus, bell peppers, red onion, spinach, kale, celery, carrots, cucumber, cherry tomatoes, sweet potato

Good fats: extra virgin olive oil

Extras: Dijon mustard, smoked paprika, oregano, thyme, cinnamon, vanilla, garlic, fresh parsley, dill, cilantro

The Fridge Door Cheat Sheet

Stick this where you will see it.

Every week:

- Three sessions, never two hard days back to back.
- Add a little weight, or one more rep, to at least one movement.
- Write down the weight and the reps. If it is not written down it did not happen.
- Walk on the days you do not train.

Every day:

- A real protein at every meal, aiming at 0.7g per pound of body weight.
- Protein on the plate before the starch.
- Water before you decide you are hungry.
- Seven hours of sleep, because that is when the muscle is actually built.

Ignore:

- Any workout sold as targeting one body part. You cannot choose where fat comes off, and a guide that says otherwise is selling you a thing that does not exist.
- The scale, day to day. Weigh weekly if at all, and judge the eight weeks on a photograph.

Make It Stick

You do not need all of this. Pick the three things below and make them automatic before you add anything else.

1. Three sessions a week, on the schedule, with the weight written down.
2. A real protein at every meal, aiming at the number on the food page.
3. Add either a little weight or one more rep, every single week.

Do that for eight weeks and then look at a photograph, not at the mirror and not at the scale. The scale moves for a dozen reasons that have nothing to do with your body composition, and the mirror has seen you every day so it cannot see the change at all.

Eight weeks is not long. It is two months of three short sessions a week. The people who get results are almost never the ones who trained hardest, they are the ones who were still doing it in week seven.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Reach Back Out

This guide was shared with you by someone who can help you go further with it.

Message them. Tell them which of the eight workouts you started with, and what your protein number came out at. They can help you adjust the schedule to your week and answer anything the guide left open.

Eight weeks is much easier with someone checking in. That is the whole reason they sent it.

The Small Print

This guide is general fitness and wellness information for educational purposes only. It is not medical, nutritional, diagnostic or treatment advice, and it is not a weight loss program.

We are not physicians, registered dietitians, physiotherapists or licensed healthcare providers. This content is not a substitute for professional advice.

Consult your physician or a qualified healthcare provider before beginning any exercise or nutrition program, especially if you are pregnant, nursing, have an injury or an existing medical condition, or take medication.

Individual results vary and no particular outcome is guaranteed. Stop any exercise that causes pain.

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